



Facilitator Guide

THE INFINITY MAP CHURCH WORKSHOP

“Because love plans ahead.”

HomeTown Ministries International

InfinityMap.org · michael@hometownministries.com

3 Crosses. 2 Choices. 1 Savior.

The most loving work your church will do this year

Thank you for saying yes to leading this workshop. Over the next several weeks, you'll walk families through something most of them have avoided for years — and by the end, they'll thank you for it.

Here's the heart of it: when the Lord calls one of us home, our families face hundreds of decisions in their hardest hours. Where are the papers? What were their wishes? Who do we call? The Infinity Map gathers every answer into one book — personal history, medical directives, finances, funeral wishes, and the faith and wisdom worth passing on.

“A good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children.” — Proverbs 13:22

What this workshop is

- A guided, unhurried walk through the Infinity Map workbook — together, so nobody faces it alone.
- A ministry of preparation and hope, anchored each week in scripture and prayer.
- A gift each household finishes: a completed plan their family can find when it matters most.

What this workshop is not

- **Not legal, medical, or financial advice.** The workbook organizes wishes and information; encourage families to bring the finished Map to an attorney for wills and powers of attorney.
- **Not group therapy or public sharing.** Workbooks are completed privately at home. The group exists for encouragement, teaching, and prayer — never for disclosing personal details.
- **Not morbid.** Keep the tone where scripture puts it: planning ahead is an act of love, not a surrender to fear.

You don't need special training. If you can open a meeting in prayer, read a scripture, and keep a conversation warm, you can facilitate this workshop. This guide gives you everything else.

What's in your church package

- **The Infinity Map workbook** — one per household, as a fillable PDF. Households may type into it on a computer or print it and write by hand. Print copies for those without computers.
- **This 12-page Facilitator Guide** — your role, the session rhythm, and pastoral guidance.
- **The Workshop Curriculum** — a complete weekly plan: prayers, scripture, teaching notes, workbook assignments, and discussion prompts for every session.
- **The Legacy Sunday Promo Kit** — pulpit script, bulletin inserts, and a coordinator's checklist for filling the room.

Choose your pace: 5 weeks or 8 weeks

Both tracks cover the whole workbook. Choose based on your calendar and your congregation.

Track	Best for
8-week track	The gentler walk — one theme at a time, more discussion, more room for tender moments. Ideal for Sunday school quarters and midweek small groups.
5-week track	The focused season — pairs related themes into single sessions. Ideal for a sermon-series companion or a shorter church calendar window.

Which workbook sections happen when? The full week-by-week map — with the 5-week combinations — is in the Workshop Curriculum. This guide covers *how* to lead; the curriculum covers *what* each week holds.

Group size and rooms

- Any size works. Under 15, keep one circle. Over 15, teach together, then break into table groups of 6–8 for discussion.
- Choose a warm, private room — not the lobby. This subject deserves a door that closes.
- Same room, same time, every week. Consistency is kindness to older participants.

Shepherd, not expert

Families don't need you to know probate law. They need you to make a hard subject feel safe, keep the group moving, and point everything back to love and to Christ. That's the whole job.

You are...

- **The tone-setter.** If you're warm and unafraid, the room will be too. Begin every session with the confidence that this is good work, commanded by wisdom and carried by hope.
- **The timekeeper.** Honor the schedule. Older participants tire; families have evenings. Start on time, end on time.
- **The encourager.** Progress over perfection. A workbook half-finished is infinitely better than one never started — say so often.
- **The prayer.** Every session opens and closes in prayer. When a tender moment rises mid-session, pausing to pray is always the right call.

You are not...

- **A lawyer.** “That's a wonderful question for an attorney — and your finished Map will make that meeting faster and cheaper.”
- **A financial advisor.** The workbook records where things are, never advice about what to do with them.
- **A grief counselor.** You will meet grief in this room. Love people well in the moment, then connect them with your pastor for ongoing care.

The one sentence to memorize: “I can't answer that as an expert — but let's capture the question in your Map, so you ask the right professional and your family has the answer forever.”

Co-facilitating

Two leaders are better than one — one teaches while the other watches the room for the person quietly struggling. Married couples and pastor-plus-deacon pairs both work beautifully.

The 60–75 minute session, every week

Every session in the curriculum follows the same rhythm. Predictability builds trust — by week three, the room will settle into it like a favorite pew.

Minutes	Movement
0–5	Gather & opening prayer. Welcome by name. Pray the week's opening prayer from the curriculum.
5–15	Scripture & teaching. Read the week's passage aloud. Share the teaching notes in your own words — ten minutes, not thirty.
15–25	Walk the pages. Open the workbook to this week's sections. Show what's there, explain anything unfamiliar, name the parts people tend to skip.
25–50	Discussion. Use the week's prompts. Let stories breathe. You're aiming for courage, not completion — the writing happens at home.
50–60	The week's assignment & closing prayer. Name exactly which pages to complete at home. Close with the curriculum's prayer.

Three facilitation habits that change everything

- **Ask, then wait.** After a discussion prompt, count silently to ten. The best answers in this workshop come on the count of eight.
- **Catch the deflection.** Humor is how people flee this subject. Laugh along, then return gently: “And truly — what would you want?”
- **End with the win.** Close every session by naming what the room just accomplished: “Tonight, your families got safer.”

When the room gets tender

Somewhere in these weeks, it will happen: a widow reaches the funeral pages her husband never filled in; a man realizes his children don't know where anything is; someone is walking through a diagnosis right now. This isn't the workshop going wrong — it's the workshop working. Be ready.

In the moment

- **Don't rush past it.** Stop the agenda. The schedule serves the people, never the reverse.
- **Acknowledge simply.** “That's a heavy one. Thank you for trusting us with it.” Resist the urge to fix.
- **Pray right then.** A thirty-second prayer over a hurting person is worth more than any teaching point you'll skip.
- **Offer the exit.** Some need to step out. Have a co-facilitator or mature member ready to go with them — nobody leaves the room hurting and alone.

Afterward

- Follow up within 48 hours — a call, not a text, for anything that cracked open.
- Tell your pastor (with the person's permission) when a need is bigger than a moment.
- Keep confidences absolutely. One broken confidence ends a workshop's trust for everyone.

Watch for the quiet ones. The person most affected is often the one who says nothing and stops bringing their workbook. An unpressured “How's it going with your Map?” in the hallway can reopen a door.

Grief in the room

Recent loss doesn't disqualify participation — some grieving people find this work deeply healing — but give them explicit freedom: “Take the weeks you need; skip any page; there is no behind here.”

The rules that make the room safe

The Infinity Map holds Social Security numbers, medical wishes, and financial information. The workshop only works if every participant trusts that their private life stays private. Read these ground rules aloud in week one, and re-read them any week a new face joins.

Ground rules — read aloud:

- Your workbook is **yours alone**. It stays home, or closed in your bag. No one — including your facilitator — will ever ask to see inside it.
- We discuss **the topics, never the answers**. “I found the medical section hard” is for the group; which box you checked is not.
- What's shared here **stays here**. Stories offered in this room are not retold — not even as prayer requests — without permission.
- Complete the sensitive pages **at home**, not in the room. Never bring account numbers to church.

Guidance to repeat during the finance weeks

- The workbook itself says it: **last four digits only** for account numbers. The Map records *where* things are, not the keys to them.
- Completed Maps belong in a fireproof box, a safe, or with vital documents — and one trusted person told where.
- Never email a completed Map. Paper and their own computer only.

For the church's part

- Keep no roster of who has or hasn't completed anything. Attendance, yes; contents, never.
- If a participant asks the church to hold a sealed copy, involve your pastor and treat it like any vital record entrusted to the church.

The practical checklist

Four weeks out

- Set the track (5 or 8 weeks), the day, the time, and the room.
- Name a coordinator for sign-ups (this can be you, but it's better shared).
- Print workbooks for households without computers — single-sided, three-hole punched, in a binder they can add to. A binder says “this matters.”

Two weeks out

- Legacy Sunday: pulpit announcement two Sundays running (script in the Promo Kit), bulletin insert both weeks.
- Personal invitations beat announcements. Have your coordinator directly invite the widowed, the retired, and young parents — the three groups who need this most and sign up least.

Week one

- Distribute workbooks. Walk everyone to the download page or hand them their binder.
- Read the privacy ground rules aloud (page 7).
- Set expectations: writing happens at home; the group is for courage.

Every week

- Room set warm: circle or tables, never rows. Coffee helps more than you'd think.
- Bring spare printed copies of the week's pages for anyone who forgot theirs.
- Send a midweek nudge — one text: this week's pages and one encouraging line.

Budget note: your package covers every household's workbook. The only real costs left are printing and coffee — a church of any size can afford this ministry.

Answers you can give word-for-word

“Is this legally binding?”

“No — and that's by design. The Map organizes your wishes and information so your family isn't searching. For a will, living will, or power of attorney, take your finished Map to an attorney; you'll walk in so prepared it saves you time and money.”

“I'm young and healthy. Why would I do this now?”

“Because this isn't about age — it's about love. And honestly, the people who most need a plan are young parents. If something happened tomorrow, would anyone know your wishes for your kids?”

“Isn't this morbid? I don't want to dwell on death.”

“Scripture calls it wisdom, not gloom: *‘Teach us to number our days, that we may gain a heart of wisdom’* (Psalm 90:12). And ask anyone who's finished one — they'll tell you it feels like relief, not darkness.”

“My spouse won't participate. Should I still?”

“Yes. One completed Map protects the whole household more than none. And in our experience, a finished Map on the kitchen table is the best recruiter a spouse ever had.”

“What if my family fights about what I write?”

“Families fight when wishes are *unknown* — that's when everyone's guess feels equally right. Writing it down doesn't start the argument; it ends it before it can begin.”

“Do I have to share what I wrote?”

“Never. Your Map is yours alone. All we ask is that your family knows it exists and where to find it.”

When you don't know: “I don't know — and I'd rather tell you that than guess. Write the question in your Map's margin, and let's find who can answer it.”

After the last session

The closing celebration

Don't let the workshop just stop — land it. In the final session (the curriculum builds this in):

- **Mark the moment.** A blessing prayed over the group, a certificate, or a simple shared meal. Completing this work is worth honoring.
- **The two commissions.** Send everyone home with the same charge: *store your Map where family can find it, and tell one person where it is.* A finished Map nobody can find helps nobody.
- **The Sunday testimony.** Ask one or two willing participants to share sixty seconds with the congregation about what this did for their family. Nothing fills the next workshop like it.

Keeping it alive

- **The yearly review.** Encourage a tradition: every New Year (or each birthday), pull the Map out and update what changed.
- **New members and new seasons.** Run the workshop annually or biannually. Every wedding, birth, diagnosis, and funeral in your church creates someone newly ready for it.
- **Raise the next facilitator.** Your best participant this round is your co-facilitator next round.

Tell us how it went

We'd love to hear the stories and pray with you — michael@hometownministries.com. Your experience also makes this workshop better for the next church.

“One generation shall commend your works to another, and shall declare your mighty acts.” — Psalm 145:4

Questions facilitators ask us

“Can I run this without a pastor present?”

Yes — deacons, elders, and lay leaders run this workshop well. Just keep your pastor informed and agree ahead of time on who handles pastoral-care follow-ups.

“Can two churches run it together?”

Wonderful idea for small congregations — each church purchases its own package for its own households, and you share the teaching load.

“What about members who join at week three?”

Welcome them, hand them a workbook, and pair them with a buddy who'll summarize what's passed. The workbook is self-explanatory enough to catch up at home.

“Someone wants to buy extra copies for family out of state.”

Send them to [InfinityMap.org](https://www.infinitymap.org) — individual Essentials and Legacy editions are available there anytime.

“Can we adapt the schedule? Skip a week? Split a session?”

Freely. The curriculum is a trellis, not a cage. Keep the opening prayer, the scripture, and the assignment — everything else can flex to your church.

“What if attendance drops mid-series?”

Normal — life happens. The midweek nudge (one text) is your best retention tool, and the closing celebration announced early gives everyone a finish line worth returning for.

“Is there anything we're licensed to copy?”

Your package covers one Infinity Map per household in your congregation, plus printing of curriculum pages for participants. Please don't share the files beyond your church family — this ministry grows when churches partner with it honestly.



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